

3. Need Finding II - Query Techniques

Interazione Uomo Macchina
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Tecniche principali di need finding

- **interviste**
- interviste specifiche:
 - ai lead users
 - agli extreme users
 - a esperti
 - history interviews, process mapping, laddering, cultural context, intercepts
- questionari
- diario
- pager studies
- camera studies

Interviste

Interviste

- Informali, economiche
- Permettono di approfondire
- Possono far scoprire informazioni inaspettate
- Sono soggettive
- Time consuming

Intervistare: chi?

- Persone rappresentative degli utenti
- Utenti di un sistema simile
- Persone che non sono utenti potenziali

Come trovare partecipanti

- Usare i social network
- Amici di amici
- Incentivare se possibile
- Partecipanti non ideali: meglio di niente!
- Tutti hanno qualcosa interessante da dire

Alcune linee guida

- preparare prima le domande
- registrare l'intervista (o avere qualcuno che prende appunti)
- chiedere il consenso per privacy
- incoraggiare l'intervistato ad approfondire le risposte date
- rimanere neutrali rispetto alle posizioni espresse dall'intervistato

Attenzione alle domande

- evitare quelle:
 - la cui risposta è scontata
 - che contengono la risposta
 - troppo generiche
 - che chiedono all'utente di sostituirsi al designer
 - basate su scenari ipotetici
 - che chiedono quanto spesso o ogni quanto fai qualcosa
 - che prevedono come risposta sì/no
 - che cominciano con "ti piacerebbe...?" o "useresti...?"
- meglio:
 - quelle che prevedono risposte aperte
 - andare sul concreto, essere specifici
 - focalizzarsi su situazioni note all'intervistato
 - chiedere quando (ma non lontano nel tempo)

DILEMMA

What They Say and What They Do

What users say isn't always what they do. People sometimes give the answers that they think show them in the best light, they may have forgotten what happened, or they may want to please the interviewer by answering in the way they think will satisfy them. This may be problematic when the interviewer and interviewee don't know each other, especially if the interview is being conducted remotely by Skype, Cisco Webex, or another digital conferencing system.

For example, Yvonne Rogers et al. (2010) conducted a study to investigate whether a set of twinkly lights embedded in the floor of an office building could persuade people to take the stairs rather than the lift (or elevator). In interviews, participants told the researchers that they did not change their behavior but logged data showed that their behavior did, in fact, change significantly. So, can interviewers believe all of the responses they get? Are the respondents telling the truth, or are they simply giving the answers that they think the interviewer wants to hear?

It isn't possible to avoid this behavior, but an interviewer can be aware of it and reduce such biases by choosing questions carefully, by getting a large number of participants, or by using a combination of data gathering techniques. ■

Helen Sharp, Yvonne Rogers, Jenny Preece
"Interaction Design: Beyond human-computer interaction"

Running the interview

Before starting, make sure that the goals of the interview have been explained to the interviewee and that they are willing to proceed. Finding out about the interviewee and their environment before the interview will make it easier to put them at ease, especially if it is an unfamiliar setting.

During the interview, it is better to listen more than to talk, to respond with sympathy but without bias, and to appear to enjoy the interview. The following is a common sequence for an interview (Robson and McCartan, 2016):

1. An introduction in which the interviewer introduces themselves and explains why they are doing the interview, reassures interviewees regarding any ethical issues, and asks if they mind being recorded, if appropriate. This should be exactly the same for each interviewee.
2. A warm-up session where easy, non-threatening questions come first. These may include questions about demographic information, such as “What area of the country do you live in?”
3. A main session in which the questions are presented in a logical sequence, with the more probing ones at the end. In a semi-structured interview, the order of questions may vary between participants, depending on the course of the conversation, how much probing is done, and what seems more natural.
4. A cooling-off period consisting of a few easy questions (to defuse any tension that may have arisen).
5. A closing session in which the interviewer thanks the interviewee and switches off the recorder or puts their notebook away, signaling that the interview has ended.